

UNIVERSITY OF CALCUTTA



SURENDRANATH LAW COLLEGE

Academic Year: 2023-24

Department: Law (B.A.LLB)

Sub: Sociology III

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Semester: 3

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Date of Submission:

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Reason for Choosing the Topic

India's geographic location and socio-economic conditions make it particularly vulnerable to narcotic drug and human trafficking. These issues have far-reaching consequences on individuals, families, and society. Investigating the root causes and the government's response provides critical insights into combating such pervasive problems.

Research Questions

1. What are the main causes of narcotic drug and women trafficking in India?
2. How do geographic, economic, and social factors contribute to these issues?
3. What role has the Indian government played in combating drug and human trafficking?
4. What measures could improve the effectiveness of anti-trafficking and anti-drug initiatives?

Hypothesis

India's vulnerability to narcotic drug and human trafficking arises from its geographic position, socio-economic disparities, and inadequate law enforcement. Effective government policies, combined with community-level interventions, can significantly reduce these issues.

Introduction

India, situated near major drug-producing regions like the Golden Crescent and the Golden Triangle, is highly susceptible to narcotic drug trafficking. Additionally, socio-economic inequalities and gender-based violence make women vulnerable to human trafficking. These twin issues undermine national security and human rights.

This note critically examines the root causes of these problems and evaluates the role of the government in addressing them. The discussion aims to highlight gaps in current approaches and suggest actionable solutions.

Causes of Vulnerability in India

1. Geographic and Economic Factors

India's proximity to major drug-producing regions facilitates smuggling. The porous borders with countries like Afghanistan, Myanmar, and Nepal exacerbate the problem.

Economic factors such as poverty, unemployment, and lack of education increase vulnerability, making individuals susceptible to trafficking and drug abuse.

2. Socio-cultural and Political Challenges

Deep-rooted gender inequalities and social stigmas often push women into trafficking. Corruption and inefficiencies in law enforcement create an environment where traffickers operate with impunity.

3. Weak Law Enforcement

While India has laws like the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act and the Immoral Traffic (Prevention) Act, their enforcement is often weak due to lack of training, resources, and coordination among agencies.

Role of Government in Combating Drug and Trafficking Problems

1. Legislative Frameworks

- The government has introduced laws such as:
- The Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act, 1985
- Immoral Traffic (Prevention) Act (ITPA), 1956
- Juvenile Justice (Care and Protection of Children) Act, 2015
- These aim to curb drug abuse, trafficking, and protect victims.

2. Enforcement Mechanisms

Agencies like the Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB) and Anti-Human Trafficking Units (AHTU) have been established to monitor and combat trafficking networks.

3. Rehabilitation and Awareness Programs

Programs like Nasha Mukta Bharat Abhiyaan aim to reduce drug addiction. Awareness campaigns targeting vulnerable communities educate them about the risks of trafficking.

Critically Examining the Current Scenario

1. Successes

Increased collaboration with international agencies has led to higher drug seizures.

Shelters and rehabilitation centers have helped trafficking survivors reintegrate into society.

2. Gaps and Challenges

Corruption and lack of inter-agency coordination remain major barriers.

Victim-centric approaches are often neglected, and traffickers escape with minor penalties.

Rehabilitation programs for drug users and trafficking victims are underfunded.

Conclusion

India's vulnerability to narcotic drug and women trafficking stems from its geographic, economic, and social context. While the government has implemented laws and programs, challenges in enforcement and rehabilitation persist. Strengthening inter-agency coordination, increasing funding for victim rehabilitation, and empowering vulnerable communities through education and economic opportunities are essential to address these issues effectively.